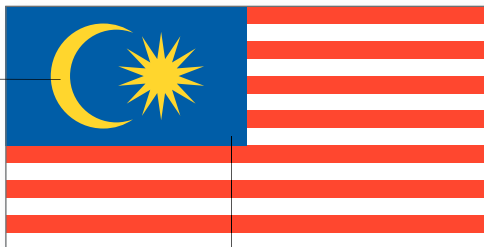


Malaysia

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** September 16, 1963 **Usage:** National and Civil

*The crescent
and star of
Islam*



The 14 red
and white
stripes for the
14 states of
the Federation

*The blue canton represents unity
of the Malaysian people*

Asia



Malaya became independent of Britain in 1957. In 1963, the Federation of **Malaysia** was formed, although Singapore seceded in 1965.

The first flag of independent Malaya was based on the Stars and Stripes of the United States of America, combined with Islamic symbolism. It had 11 red and white stripes and a blue canton, like the US flag, with a gold crescent and an eleven-pointed star, traditionally associated with Islam. Both the number of stripes and points on the star denoted the 11 states of the Federation.

THREE NEW STATES

In 1963 three new states—Singapore, Sabah and Sarawak—joined the Federation to form Malaysia. To reflect this the flag was amended to 14 red and white stripes representing the 14 states. When Singapore

seceded in 1965, the flag remained unaltered. The fourteenth stripe is now said to stand for the federal district of Kuala Lumpur.

THE SYMBOLISM OF THE COLORS

The blue canton represents the unity of the Malaysian people. The crescent is for Islam, the dominant religion. The 14 points of the star are for unity among the states of the country. Yellow is the traditional color of the rulers of the Malay states. Red and white are also traditional colors in Southeast Asia.

The national motto appears on a scroll in the coat of arms. It is repeated in both Jawi and Roman script and means “Unity is Strength.”